

KALE REALTY

27 PERCENT. NOT THE MARKET YOU THINK.

NAR just asked REALTORS what's really blocking their buyers. It wasn't inventory.

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**12 PERCENT BLAME
INVENTORY. 27
PERCENT BLAME
AFFORDABILITY.**

That's REALTORS surveyed nationwide, naming the biggest reason their own clients aren't buying.

AFFORDABILITY ALONE OUTWEIGHS INVENTORY AND FIT COMBINED.

NAR's 2026 Member Profile asked its REALTOR members the most important factor limiting their clients from making a purchase. Housing affordability topped the list at **27%**, ahead of lack of inventory (12%) and difficulty finding the right property (11%) added together. Agents keep solving the search. The data says the blocker moved to the payment.

WHAT CHANGES WHEN THE PAYMENT IS THE OBJECTION:

- 1 Bring the lender into the first conversation, not the third.**

A payment scenario answers the real objection faster than another listing.

- 2 Show the monthly number before the sale price.**

Affordability is a payment problem, and the price alone doesn't show that.

- 3 Ask about the down payment gap up front.**

It surfaces the actual blocker instead of guessing at "the wrong house" for weeks.

THE TAKEAWAY

STOP SOLVING THE SEARCH. START SOLVING THE PAYMENT.

27 percent of your peers already told NAR that's where the deal actually gets stuck.